

1. We have no choice about what God knew in the past.
2. In the past, God had foreknowledge of our future actions.
3. We have no choice about the fact that God knows that in the future I will perform a certain action. (1,2)
4. If we have no choice about some facts, and those facts necessitate X, we have no choice about X.
5. God knowing that we will perform some action necessitates that we will perform that action.

- C. We have no choice about whether we will perform our future actions. (3,4,5)

THE FOREKNOWLEDGE ARGUMENT

1. We have no choice about past facts.
 - 2*. In the past, there were truths about all of our future actions.
 3. We have no choice about the fact that God knows that in the future I will perform a certain action. (1,2)
 4. If we have no choice about p, and no choice about the fact that if p, then q, then we have no choice about q.
 - 5*. We have no choice about the fact that if it is true that I will perform some action, then I will perform that action.
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C. We have no choice about whether we will perform our future actions.
(3,4,5)

The fatalist argument

We'll soon consider some possible responses to Edwards' argument.

But before we do that, let's ask: can we come up with an argument similar to the Foreknowledge Argument which is based, not on foreknowledge, but on fate?

we can.

Notice that the only independent premises which say anything about God's foreknowledge are (1), (2) and (5).

What happens if we replace those with premises that just talk about there being truths about the future?

1. We have no choice about past facts.
2. In the past, **there were truths about** our future actions.
3. We have no choice about the truth that in the future I will perform a certain action. (1,2)
4. If we have no choice about some facts, and those facts necessitate X, we have no choice about X.
5. It being true that we will perform some action necessitates that we will perform that action.

C. We have no choice about whether we will perform our future actions. (3,4,5)

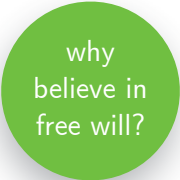
THE FATALIST ARGUMENT



two
arguments
against free
will



is fate
real?



why
believe in
free will?



three
ways out



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indirectly.

1 We have no doubt what God knew in

perform future actions. (3,4,5)

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5. Good knowing that we will perform some

and those facts need sit at X , we have



2. In the past, God had foreknowledge of

C. We have no choice about whether we will

4. If we have no choice about some facts,





3. We have not checked that

action necessitates that we will perform

God knows that in the future I will





2* In the past, there were trials about

some action, then I will perform that

(3, 4, 5)

Goodbye to that little girl

performa certain action (1,2)

1. **Introduction**

2. **Background**

3. **Methodology**

4. **Results**

5. **Discussion**

6. **Conclusion**

7. **References**

8. **Appendix**

5* We have established the fact

that if it is true that I will prefer

4. If we have no choice about p , and no

then we have the choice about q.

will perform various actions.

choice about the fact that if p , then q ,

all of our activities.

3 We have not heard that

1. We have no advice about past facts.

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possible responses to Edwards'

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argument.

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1. We have no choice about past

3. We have no other attributes

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4. If we have no idea about



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C. We have no idea about

first three actions: (3,4,5)

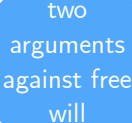
whether we will perform our

perform some action



freedom that comes from fate.

Our first topic today is the oldest challenge to the existence of free will: the challenge to



two
arguments
against free
will



is fate
real?



why
believe in
free will?



three
ways out

a Predictor. By the above line of thought, this person would lack free will. But

never had any. So they lacked free will before getting a Predicto.

So now consider a possible scenario in which someone exactly like you would get

that Predict did not **take away** their free will; it just shows them that they

But this person was stipulated to be exactly like you. So you don't have free will,

either.

things as fate, then there is no free will.

So far we've looked at two imaginary thought experiments—the story of Osmo,

and the example of the Predictor — which seem to show that if there is such a

Our question is: do either fatigue or foreknowledge pose a

serious challenge to the reality of free will?

first let's think about how Edwards'

responding to Edwards' argument. But

We'll shortly consider some ways of

for fatalsn.

argument might be related to an argument

actions. Could they give an argument

there were truths about all our future

Edwards' argument — but did believe that

God— and hence rejected premise (2) of

similar to Edwards' argument?

Suppose that someone did not believe in

replace reference to God's foreknowledge

God only shows up in premises (2) and

our future actions.

(5) Let's look at what happens if we

with reference to the being of truth about

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The fatalist argument

the 1990s, the number of people with a mental health problem has increased by 50% (Mental Health Foundation 2000).

There is a growing awareness of the need to address the needs of people with mental health problems in the community. The Department of Health (1999) has set out a vision for the future of mental health services, which includes a focus on preventing mental health problems, supporting people with mental health problems in the community, and providing specialist services for people with severe mental health problems. The Department of Health (1999) also states that the future of mental health services should be based on a partnership between the NHS, local authorities, and the voluntary sector.

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